

Journal Entry

by

Charles B. Gordon



IT'S BEEN TOUGH to date to learn many details of Jimmy Yawn's being drafted by the New York Yankees. In fact, that whole free agent baseball draft is a puzzler.

But the young Ole Miss baseball star who learned the game on the sandlots and juvenile diamonds of McComb has become a member of the vaunted Yankee organization.

For one, I believe Jimmy'll make it. It isn't simple — as George Lott and many another promising boy who's gone up will testify. But it can be done.

Be at Rotary Field tonight to pay tribute to Jimmy. There will be many features, all of them interesting.

TWO REGULAR games of baseball will be played. At 5:30 p. m. Mechanics Bank and Illinois Central Service Club of the Dixie Boys league will take the field.

When that game is over the

Jimmy Yawn Day program will be held. It will be brief. Then Yawn and a group of fellow star athletes of today and yesterday will take the field to play a 4-inning fastpitch softball game against the top-rated McComb Independents.

Parker Auto Parts and Williams Grocery of Dixie Senior Baseball will play their regularly scheduled game afterward.

Everybody must have a \$1 ticket — except boys in baseball uniform.

A STANDOUT JEWISH star has long been the dream of every manager and other executive of every New York City baseball organization, beginning (and maybe antedating) the late John McGraw.

The New Yorkers missed out on Hank Greenberg and the one or two other Jewish boys who made it big. Back in McGraw's day such players as Andy Cohen never quite cut the mus-

Only Uniformed Boys Get in Free Tonight

All who enter Rotary Field tonight for the Jimmy Yawn Day program and the regularly scheduled Dixie Boys and Dixie Senior baseball games—the first of which will start at 5:30 p. m.—must have a ticket, with one exception.

The exception is the boy in baseball uniform. Members of Dixie Youth teams of the area, or of the leagues that normally play at Rotary Field will get in free.

Tickets are on sale at \$1 each by many members of Rotary and others, and will be sold at the gate at Rotary Field beginning at about 5 p. m.

Proceeds from the ticket sale go into the Rotary's program for providing baseball for boys 13-17.

tard.

The Yanks let the promising, but wholly unproved, rookie, Mike Epstein, get away a few days ago. Now they have signed, as a first draft choice, a high school boy from Atlanta named Ronnie Blomberg.

Blomberg carries a "can't miss" tag and may prove someday to be just what the Yankees need to provide baseball "identification" with the biggest readymade audience of Hebrew fans outside of Jerusalem.

JEHU BRABHAM of Ferriday, La., one of the most-sought after athletes of Louisiana, was signed to a grant-in-aid scholarship a few days ago by Mississippi College.

Brabham is the son of Mr.

and Mrs. Welton Brabham of Ferriday. He is the grandson of former Pike County Sheriff and Mrs. Jehu W. Brabham.

Brabham was merely All-State and All-American in basketball, All-State end in football, and a two time winner of the Mel Ott award for baseball, at Ferriday High.

He was also Mr. Ferriday High, president of the Student Council, president of the Key, Beta and "F" clubs, a championship debater, in Who's Who, president of the Baptist Church Youth Choir, and served recently as youth minister.

(Wonder how he is at handball, skiing, curling, frugging, badminton, archery, water polo, bobsledding, and legerdemain?)

He is 18.

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